음식 이름 소리대로: 떡볶이[떡뽀끼]

Read Korean food names the way Korean speakers actually say them, using four common sound-change rules.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

By the end, you can read food names like 떡볶이, 국물 and 볶음밥 and say their real sounds, such as [떡뽀끼], [궁물] and [보끔밥].

1 THE LETTERS

LETTER	SOUND

1. 받침 + ㅇ → 받침이 넘어감

볶음밥 [보끔밥]

Final consonant slides to the next syllable, like 'an apple' → 'a-napple'.

TRACE AND COPY

2. ㄱ·ㄷ·ㅂ + ㄱ·ㄷ·ㅂ·ㅅ·ㅈ → 된소리

떡국 [떡꾹], 국수 [국쑤]

The second consonant turns tense with no puff of air, like 'k' in 'sky'.

TRACE AND COPY

3. ㄱ·ㅂ + ㄴ·ㅁ → ㅇ·ㅁ

국물 [궁물]

ㄱ turns into 'ng' (as in 'sing'), and ㅂ into 'm', before n or m.

TRACE AND COPY

4. ㄱ·ㅂ + ㅎ → ㅋ·ㅍ

식혜 [시케]

ㅎ joins the ㄱ or ㅂ before it and makes a strong, breathy k or p.

TRACE AND COPY

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2 NOW THE WORDS

WORD	MEANING	IN USE
떡볶이 *tteokbokki*	tteokbokki (spicy stir-fried rice cakes); say [떡뽀끼], rules 1 and 2	떡볶이 하나 주세요. One tteokbokki, please.
국물 *gungmul*	soup broth; say [궁물]	국물이 뜨거워요. The broth is hot.
떡국 *tteokguk*	rice cake soup; say [떡꾹]	아침에 떡국을 먹었어요. I had rice cake soup for breakfast.
국수 *guksu*	noodles; say [국쑤]	점심에 국수 먹을까요? Shall we have noodles for lunch?
볶음밥 *bokkeumbap*	fried rice; say [보끔밥]	볶음밥 두 개 주세요. Two fried rice, please.
식혜 *sikhye*	sikhye (sweet rice drink); say [시케]	식혜 한 잔 주세요. A glass of sikhye, please.

3 YOUR TURN

READ FOOD WORDS ALOUD

Use the four rules in the box to find how each word really sounds.

1. Choose the real sound:
   ① 국밥 → [국밥] / [국빱] ② 밥물 → [밤물] / [밥물] ③ 국을 → [국을] / [구글]
2. Write the real sound in [ ]:
   ① 밥은 ② 떡만 ③ 밥하고
3. Which rule (1–4) do you hear?
   ① 식당 [식땅] ② 라면을 [라며늘] ③ 국하고 [구카고]
4. Is the sound in [ ] right? Write O or X. If X, write the right sound:
   ① 떡집 [떡찝] ② 밥만 [밥만] ③ 떡을 [떠글]
5. Read aloud and write the sounds in [ ]:
   ① 밥을 먹어요. ② 떡하고 우유 주세요.

✓ ANSWERS

1) ① [국빱] ② [밤물] ③ [구글]
2) ① [바븐] ② [떵만] ③ [바파고]
3) ① 2 (tense sound) ② 1 (slides over) ③ 4 (ㅎ makes it strong)
4) ① O ② X → [밤만] ③ O
5) ① [바블 머거요] ② [떠카고 우유 주세요]

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